

Richard's Playoff Pool LXI Rulebook

NFL Playoff Pool — Full Rulebook

Season 2026-2027 · Last updated October 2026

1. Overview

This pool runs across the NFL Playoff season — Wild Card through Super Bowl — and is divided into three separate contests. Each player participates individually using a unique player code issued by the Pool Manager. All picks and results are tracked through the pool app.

The three pools are:

- **Pool #1 — Visible Score Predictions:** Pick scores for every playoff game. Picks are visible to all players immediately after submission.
- **Pool #2 — Blind Score Predictions:** Pick scores for every playoff game. Picks remain hidden from other players until the weekly submission deadline (Friday 11:59 PM PST).
- **Pool #3 — Super Bowl Prediction:** A one-time entry during Wild Card week only. Predict the Super Bowl matchup, the point spread outcome, and the over/under result.

Players may enter all three pools. Pools #1 and #2 run every playoff week. Pool #3 is entered once during Wild Card week and applies to the Super Bowl only.

2. Registration & Player Codes

Each player receives a unique **player code** from the Pool Manager before the season begins. This code is required to log in to the pool app and submit picks.

- Player codes are case-sensitive and must be kept confidential.
 - If a player loses their code, they must contact the Pool Manager to have it reissued.
 - Players may not share codes or submit picks on behalf of another player.
 - A player code is valid for the entire playoff season once issued.
 - The Pool Manager holds separate **Pool Manager codes** (PM codes) that grant administrative access to the app. PM codes must never be shared with players.
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3. Pool #1 — Visible Score Predictions

Pool #1 runs every playoff week, including Wild Card, Divisional, Conference Championship, and Super Bowl.

How it works:

1. Log in with your player code.
2. For each game that week, enter a predicted final score for both teams.
3. Submit your picks before the weekly deadline (see Section 7).
4. Once submitted, your picks are immediately visible to all other players.

Scoring:

- **Winner correct:** 1 point
- **Exact score (both teams):** 3 bonus points
- **Closest score (if no exact match):** 1 bonus point per team (2 maximum)

Picks cannot be changed after submission. If the week is locked (past the deadline), the submission form closes and no new picks can be entered.

RNG (Random Number Generator):

Players may use the RNG button to auto-fill random scores. This is for convenience only — the player remains responsible for reviewing and submitting the generated picks. The RNG button is hidden once the week is locked.

4. Pool #2 — Blind Score Predictions

Pool #2 runs every playoff week with the same game slate as Pool #1.

How it works:

1. Log in with your player code.
2. Enter a predicted final score for both teams in each game.
3. Submit your picks before the weekly deadline (Friday 11:59 PM PST).
4. Your picks remain hidden from all other players until the deadline passes. After the deadline, all Pool #2 picks for that week become visible.

Scoring:

- Same scoring rules as Pool #1: 1 point for correct winner, 3 points for exact score, up to 2 bonus points for closest score.

Because picks are hidden until the deadline, Pool #2 rewards independent judgment — players cannot see others' picks to inform their own until it is too late.

Picks cannot be changed after submission. The RNG button works the same as in Pool #1 and is hidden once the week is locked.

5. Pool #3 — Super Bowl Prediction

Pool #3 is a one-time, season-long contest entered during **Wild Card week only**. It predicts the outcome of the Super Bowl before the playoff bracket has been decided.

Entry window: Pool #3 is open for entry from the start of Wild Card week until the Wild Card week submission deadline. After that, the entry window permanently closes. Late entries are not accepted.

Pool #3 must be enabled by the Pool Manager before it appears in the app for players. It is visible to the Pool Manager at all times.

When Pool #3 appears: After a player has submitted both Pool #1 and Pool #2 picks for Wild Card week, the app will prompt them to complete their Pool #3 Super Bowl Prediction. Players may also navigate to Pool #3 directly from the menu.

The five prediction fields:

Field	Description
AFC Team	The AFC team you predict will reach the Super Bowl
NFC Team	The NFC team you predict will reach the Super Bowl
Favourite (spread)	The team favoured to win, with a point spread of -3.5
ATS Winner	The team you predict to cover the spread (win against the spread)
O/U Line	The projected total points line set for the Super Bowl

Scoring (maximum 8 points):

Prediction	Points
Super Bowl winner correct	2 pts
ATS Winner correct	3 pts
Over/Under correct	1 pt
Exact AFC + NFC matchup correct (both teams)	2 pts bonus

Note: The AFC and NFC team predictions themselves are not individually scored — they are used to determine whether the exact matchup bonus applies.

6. Scoring Summary

Pool	Points Available	Notes
Pool #1	Up to 5 pts per game	Visible picks; visible to all after submission
Pool #2	Up to 5 pts per game	Blind picks; visible to all after Friday 11:59 PM PST deadline
Pool #3	Up to 8 pts total (once)	Super Bowl prediction only; entered Wild Card week

Point totals accumulate across all playoff weeks for Pools #1 and #2. Pool #3 points are added after the Super Bowl result.

7. Deadlines & Week Locking

Pool #1 and Pool #2 — Weekly deadline:

- The deadline for submitting picks each week is **Friday 11:59 PM Pacific Standard Time (PST)**.
- Once the deadline passes, the week is locked. No picks can be submitted or changed after locking.

- The Pool Manager may manually lock a week early if required (e.g., if games are scheduled earlier than usual).
- The RNG button and submission forms are hidden when the week is locked.

Pool #3 — Wild Card week deadline:

- Pool #3 entries must be submitted before the Wild Card week deadline (Friday 11:59 PM PST).
- After the deadline, Pool #3 is permanently closed. No entries can be added or changed for the remainder of the season.

Time Travel (Pool Manager only):

The Pool Manager has access to a Time Travel tool in the app for testing deadline behaviour. This simulates the current date and time for all users. It must be cleared after testing to prevent players from experiencing incorrect lock states.

8. Payments & Prizes

Entry fees and prize structures are set by the Pool Manager before the season begins and communicated to players directly.

- Payment is by e-transfer to the address provided by the Pool Manager.
 - Players must pay their entry fee to be considered active in the pool.
 - The Pool Manager tracks payment status in the app's Payments section.
 - Prize distribution is at the Pool Manager's discretion and is communicated at the end of the season.
 - The pool is run in good faith among participants. All disputes regarding payments or prizes are resolved by the Pool Manager.
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9. Pool Manager Functions

The Pool Manager (PM) is the administrator of the pool app and is responsible for setup, maintenance, and results entry. PM functions include:

- **Player management:** Create and issue player codes; initialize the players table via the app.
- **Week management:** Set the current playoff week; lock and unlock weeks manually if needed.
- **Pool #3 control:** Enable or disable Pool #3 visibility for players.
- **Results entry:** Enter official game scores after each week's games are complete.
- **Payments tracking:** Mark players as paid or unpaid in the Payments section.
- **Time Travel:** Simulate dates for testing purposes (must be cleared after testing).
- **PM codes:** PM codes (not player codes) grant administrative access. These must be kept secure and never shared with players.

The Pool Manager has read access to all players' picks at all times, including Pool #2 blind picks before the deadline.

10. General Rules & Conduct

1. **One entry per player.** Each player code may be used to submit one set of picks per week per pool. Sharing codes or submitting picks for other players is not permitted.
2. **No changes after submission.** Once picks are submitted, they cannot be edited or retracted.
3. **No late entries.** Picks submitted after the weekly lock are not accepted, regardless of reason.
4. **Official scores govern.** Final scores as recorded by the NFL are used to determine results. Overtime results count. Scores entered by the Pool Manager into the app are final.
5. **Pool Manager decisions are final.** In all disputes — including technical issues, score discrepancies, or payment matters — the Pool Manager's decision is final and binding.
6. **Fair play.** Players agree to submit their own picks independently. Coordinating picks with other players to manipulate standings is contrary to the spirit of the pool.
7. **Participation implies acceptance.** By participating, players accept all rules in this rulebook and any amendments communicated by the Pool Manager before the relevant week.